IELTS ACADEMIC · RESTRICTED STAFF MATERIAL

IELTS Academic Set 37

PRIVATE STAFF answer key and Listening transcript

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Answer keys and Listening transcripts are restricted to staff.

Listening

Question	Answer	Accepted variants
1	Price	
2	210	
3	stitches	
4	tension dial	
5	14th	14, fourteenth
6	18	eighteen
7	B	
8	C	
9	A	
10	B	
11	C	
12	F	
13	A	
14	H	
15	D	
16	B	
17	E	
18	G	
19	B	

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Question	Answer	Accepted variants
20	D	
21	B	
22	C	
23	A	
24	B	
25	C	
26	A	
27	B	
28	C	
29	D	
30	B	
31	nearest neighbours	
32	local rules	
33	predator pressure	
34	edge	
35	wave	
36	three	3
37	depth	
38	wind speed	
39	threat	
40	testable model	

Listening transcript

Part 1 - everyday social dialogue

Hugh Mallory	Good morning, Mallory Sewing Services. I can take the machine details first, then we will compare delivery arrangements and confirm what travels with it. Before we discuss the fault, may I check the surname for the collection label?
Eleanor Price	It is Price - P-R-I-C-E. The online form somehow recorded Pryce, so please correct that.
Hugh Mallory	Thank you. Which Alder model is it? The number should be printed beneath the carrying handle.
Eleanor Price	The label under the carrying handle says Alder 210. It is not the newer 310 model that has an automatic thread cutter.

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Hugh Mallory	What happens when you sew a normal piece of cotton: does the motor stop, or does the stitch itself change?
Eleanor Price	The machine still moves, but the stitches alternate between very short and unusually long. The needle itself was replaced last month. I mostly use the machine for ordinary clothes, never commercial work, and it has not been dropped or exposed to water.
Hugh Mallory	That history is helpful; please avoid adding oil now because it could conceal the source of friction before inspection.
Eleanor Price	The uneven result begins only after several minutes, so a quick test at the door would probably miss it.
Hugh Mallory	I will add that timing to the engineer’s sheet and ask for a longer cotton test. And where does the thread actually break? The needle area and the upper tension path point to different checks.
Eleanor Price	The break happens where the thread passes beside the tension dial. I first suspected the needle, but the snapped end is always higher up.
Hugh Mallory	I have two appointments next week. Which date can you be home after ten?
Eleanor Price	I cannot manage Monday the thirteenth, but Tuesday the fourteenth is free after ten in the morning. Please keep my neighbour’s number as a backup if I step out briefly.
Hugh Mallory	Certainly; it will be used only for access on the collection day.
Eleanor Price	If I choose collection rather than workshop drop-off, what would the Sheffield charge be?
Hugh Mallory	Home collection costs eighteen pounds. The twenty-five-pound figure applies only outside Sheffield. You mentioned the bus on your enquiry. Is carrying the case the deciding issue?
Eleanor Price	The workshop drop-off is cheaper, but the case is awkward on the bus, so home collection is the sensible choice. How soon would you complete the initial inspection, before any repair begins?
Hugh Mallory	The full repair could take a week, but the initial inspection is normally completed within three working days.
Eleanor Price	If the casing reveals another fault, how will you confirm the cost before continuing?
Hugh Mallory	Once the engineer has opened the casing, I will email a written estimate before any additional work is authorised.
Eleanor Price	Finally, which loose component should I pack separately from the other accessories?
Hugh Mallory	Leave the extension table at home, but place the loose bobbin case in a labelled envelope so it does not disappear inside the cover.
Eleanor Price	The power lead and foot pedal will both be inside the hard case, with the presser foot lowered for transport.
Hugh Mallory	Perfect. Our driver uses a padded crate and will telephone shortly before the two-hour collection window. That gives me everything I need. I will send your corrected booking through our secure customer link later tonight, and no optional work will begin until you approve the estimate.

Part 2 - everyday social monologue

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Mara Fenwick	Thanks for joining the Foxton volunteer morning. Keep the lock-flight plan in view while I identify safe routes, work points and team duties.
Mara Fenwick	For the tool store, use the small shed immediately west of the middle lock pound, reached from the towpath before the footbridge.
Mara Fenwick	Upstream is at the top of the map, and the numbered chambers step downhill towards the southern entrance.
Mara Fenwick	Wildlife screens protect a nesting strip near the reeds. Volunteers inspect from the towpath and photograph damage instead of stepping behind the barrier.
Mara Fenwick	The upper gate work area is beyond the footbridge at its north-eastern end, inside the fenced strip beside the top gate.
Mara Fenwick	The central towpath remains open to walkers, so equipment must stay inside the coned work areas rather than beside the water.
Mara Fenwick	A first-aid kit and drinking water remain at the tent, whereas personal bags belong in the staffed rest area to keep the route unobstructed.
Mara Fenwick	The spillway viewpoint stands at the far western edge, where the short gravel spur ends beside the overflow channel.
Mara Fenwick	Nobody crosses a gate beam, even when a chamber is empty; volunteers use the signed footbridge between the two paths.
Mara Fenwick	In heavy rain the painting task is cancelled, and that team joins the indoor equipment audit rather than waiting beside the exposed gates.
Mara Fenwick	The sign-in tent is just inside the south entrance, between the gate and the first bend in the towpath, not beside the café.
Mara Fenwick	The café veranda looks convenient for tools, but it is a public area and must remain clear throughout the morning.
Mara Fenwick	The morning begins with a toolbox check, since borrowed scrapers and brushes must be counted both when issued and when returned.
Mara Fenwick	The volunteer rest area occupies the grassy rectangle east of the third chamber, opposite the middle pound.
Mara Fenwick	If a boat approaches, the navigation crew controls the gates while volunteers step back behind the painted line.
Mara Fenwick	Canal staff, not volunteers, operate paddles or gate mechanisms; even experienced boaters in the group follow that restriction.
Mara Fenwick	The lower chamber is the first broad basin reached when you enter from the south and follow the towpath uphill.
Mara Fenwick	At midday all teams return borrowed brushes and grabbers to the store, then sign out at the same tent used on arrival.
Mara Fenwick	The nearest public toilets are beyond the café, while the staff washroom beside the store is not available to visitors.
Mara Fenwick	Team E begins with litter removal along the lower towpath, working uphill in pairs.

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Mara Fenwick	The lock flight has ten chambers, but volunteer work is confined to the lower six because maintenance crews are operating farther uphill.
Mara Fenwick	Volunteers working near water wear the supplied buoyancy aids and remain with their allocated partner until reassigned by a coordinator.
Mara Fenwick	The safety-rail painting is assigned to Team G, after surfaces have dried.
Mara Fenwick	Notice the difference between the overflow channel and navigable water: the spillway may look shallow, yet its stone surface is slippery and out of bounds.
Mara Fenwick	Any oil sheen, dead fish or damaged masonry is reported by radio with a location; nobody collects a sample independently.
Mara Fenwick	Team B records visitor numbers at the crossing rather than at the entrance.
Mara Fenwick	Paint teams use water-based coating only on prepared rails; they do not paint timber gates, paddle gear or historic metal plates.
Mara Fenwick	The final sweep starts at the upper work area and moves downhill, preventing cleaned sections from being crossed repeatedly by returning teams.
Mara Fenwick	Team D checks the temporary wildlife screens and reports gaps without moving the stakes.
Mara Fenwick	The visitor-count sheet separates walkers, cyclists and boat crews so the charity can plan future signs without treating every passing person alike.
Mara Fenwick	That completes the lock-flight allocation. I will check every team at midday before tools return downhill to the store.

Part 3 - educational or training discussion

Dr Carys Hume	Let us use the transfer recording carefully. I want each observation tied to something visible before we redesign the rehearsal and observation sheet.
Aled Wynn	The clearest weakness was not physical strength. The team began before confirming the chair brakes, so the sequence itself was unsafe.
Dr Carys Hume	The debrief is about learning from a controlled simulation, not assigning blame for a clinical incident.
Aled Wynn	The students agree that consent is ongoing: a person who initially agrees may ask to pause once the movement has started.
Priya Norr	The group also schedules a short review the following day, testing whether the changes are remembered without looking at the checklist.
Priya Norr	I moved the footplates late. They should have been swung away before the person came forward, not while the transfer was already under way.
Aled Wynn	I remember asking whether the volunteer was ready, but the film shows that movement began before the answer was complete.
Priya Norr	The next rehearsal will use the same chair and bed height, allowing the team to evaluate the sequence rather than a changed environment.
Dr Carys Hume	I will compare both recordings privately before the class discusses whether the revised form captured the improvement consistently in the second session.

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Dr Carys Hume	A side camera will show the spacing between feet, chair and bed; the front view hid those distances.
Priya Norr	I noticed that the original checklist collapsed preparation and movement into one broad score, concealing where the problem arose.
Dr Carys Hume	The observer will stand outside the transfer space and will not prompt unless the tutor stops the simulation for an immediate safety reason.
Aled Wynn	We agree on one short instruction at a time, followed by a pause for the person to respond.
Dr Carys Hume	I want you to distinguish an action that was absent from one that happened at the wrong time.
Aled Wynn	After rehearsal, the volunteer will comment first, before trainees explain their intentions and potentially influence that account.
Priya Norr	Before the next assessed attempt, the pair will rehearse slowly without a camera so the revised sequence becomes familiar.
Aled Wynn	They retain the volunteer's own feedback because comfort and clarity cannot be inferred from posture alone.
Priya Norr	Aled wants to score hand placement numerically, but Dr Hume prefers a short observable description because different body sizes make one fixed position misleading.
Dr Carys Hume	Aled will draft the revised sequence checklist, beginning with consent, brakes and footplates.
Priya Norr	The revised observation sheet will have separate columns for preparation, movement, communication and the volunteer's response.
Dr Carys Hume	Priya notes that eye contact disappeared during the turn, suggesting that communication should be observed throughout movement rather than only at the beginning.
Aled Wynn	Priya will redesign the communication column so observers record the instruction and the response separately.
Dr Carys Hume	The volunteer in the simulation could bear some weight, so the students were expected to support participation rather than lift the person passively.
Aled Wynn	The tutor distinguishes leading from pulling: a trainee may guide direction while still allowing the volunteer to generate part of the movement.
Priya Norr	Dr Hume will choose the second camera position after checking what the side view includes.
Aled Wynn	My stance looked stable from the front, but the side view may reveal that my feet narrowed as I turned towards the bed.
Priya Norr	One camera remains wide enough to show the environment, while the second focuses on feet and chair position without filming the volunteer's face.
Dr Carys Hume	The peer observer will test the form during rehearsal and flag any category that is hard to use in real time.
Priya Norr	I suggest recording the moment of each instruction because an instruction delivered after movement begins cannot guide the earlier action.
Dr Carys Hume	The form includes a pause box so an observer can record whether the trainee noticed hesitation and stopped appropriately.

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Aled Wynn	Priya will lead the final verbal summary because she can compare the first and revised attempts directly.
Dr Carys Hume	I would reject a single safe-or-unsafe box; the form should capture preparation, timing and response without turning observation into an essay.
Aled Wynn	During the final attempt, the tutor will not award a grade; she will compare the revised sequence with the problems identified in the first film.
Priya Norr	The revised transfer rehearsal now has an observable sequence, named responsibilities and space for the volunteer's response to guide the next debrief.

Part 4 - academic monologue

Dr Rowan Leith	Today I will walk you through a teaching simulation from our methods course. The measurements belong to the exercise, so concentrate on how the flock model behaves.
Dr Rowan Leith	A useful model begins with nearest neighbours: each bird responds to a limited social neighbourhood, not to every individual in the flock.
Dr Rowan Leith	Murmurations vary greatly in size, duration and setting, so one evening's display cannot stand for every flock.
Dr Rowan Leith	A signal to turn is not transmitted like a command through a queue; each bird responds to changing motion in its own local field.
Dr Rowan Leith	To see why validation matters, imagine that tracking software swaps two bird identities; the reconstructed path would show a false acceleration that no bird actually made.
Dr Rowan Leith	When many birds repeatedly follow local rules, an organised group pattern can emerge without a leader.
Dr Rowan Leith	The appearance of central control is deceptive because repeated neighbour-to-neighbour adjustment can coordinate a much larger pattern.
Dr Rowan Leith	The teaching simulation in our course pack shows that flocks may become denser under predator pressure, strengthening the confusion effect in its results.
Dr Rowan Leith	A bird balances alignment with neighbours, attraction towards the group and avoidance of collision; changing those priorities changes the simulated shape.
Dr Rowan Leith	Dusk also reduces contrast as the display continues, so usable observations may end before the birds enter their roost.
Dr Rowan Leith	In the second stage of our model, a disturbance may first affect birds near an edge before moving through the group rather than starting at its centre.
Dr Rowan Leith	As the model flock deforms, edge position changes continuously, so the team tracks trajectories rather than assigning permanent edge birds.
Dr Rowan Leith	Predators may provoke compression, splitting or rapid escape, but similar shapes can appear without a confirmed attack.
Dr Rowan Leith	Roost location influences the direction from which birds arrive, but arrival flow should not be confused with the interaction rules inside a dense flock.
Dr Rowan Leith	The team calls the propagated change a turning wave: orientation shifts rapidly while relative positions remain coordinated.

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Dr Rowan Leith	The camera procedure calibrates each position against fixed landmarks before paths are tracked frame by frame.
Dr Rowan Leith	Fast propagation does not mean every bird turns simultaneously, because tiny delays accumulate across the visible wave.
Dr Rowan Leith	Our Northbridge field team uses stereophotography to turn matched image coordinates into three-dimensional bird positions.
Dr Rowan Leith	Simulations explore what follows from chosen rules; they do not prove that birds perceive distance or direction in exactly the programmed way.
Dr Rowan Leith	For the field procedure, three synchronised cameras view the same event from separated positions to build a three-dimensional reconstruction.
Dr Rowan Leith	Now consider how the reconstruction is evaluated. We compare distributions of speed, spacing and turn timing, rather than asking only whether the movement looks realistic.
Dr Rowan Leith	In this tracking procedure, the software links each reconstructed position to an individual identity from one moment to the next.
Dr Rowan Leith	For our quality-control exercise, flag uncertain reconstructions instead of assuming that every three-camera match has equal precision.
Dr Rowan Leith	The reconstructed observations narrow the alternatives by comparing predicted patterns with the timing and geometry of the recorded turns.
Dr Rowan Leith	Matching the same bird across views provides a depth estimate, which a single flat image cannot supply.
Dr Rowan Leith	Two-dimensional video compresses distance, making birds at different depths appear close together unless several views are combined.
Dr Rowan Leith	Predator events are rare in our dataset, and the observations cannot manipulate risk as a laboratory task might.
Dr Rowan Leith	Each sequence records wind speed with camera conditions, preserving its environmental context.
Dr Rowan Leith	A model that fits average spacing yet fails during rapid turns may be missing how information propagates under pressure.
Dr Rowan Leith	In our comparison, flock size and wind speed are entered as separate model inputs before the movement records are compared.
Dr Rowan Leith	For the final stage, the team tests which local mechanisms remain plausible across contrasting observations rather than imposing one universal rule.
Dr Rowan Leith	A successful model should reproduce statistical relationships across several flocks, not merely imitate one memorable outline.
Dr Rowan Leith	Further studies can test alternative interaction rules against reconstructed trajectories instead of relying on visual resemblance alone.
Dr Rowan Leith	A sudden turn does not always indicate a threat; noise, obstacles or movements by other birds can produce similar visible reactions.
Dr Rowan Leith	Neighbourhood size in a model can be defined by distance or by a fixed number of nearby birds, and those alternatives generate different predictions.

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Dr Rowan Leith	In a separate comparison, examine sparse and crowded groups, but do not treat that comparison as an input to the model just described.
Dr Rowan Leith	For the final analysis, the strongest explanation connects measured movement to a testable model rather than to a striking animation alone.
Dr Rowan Leith	Alignment causes headings to converge, attraction prevents the group dispersing, and short-range repulsion reduces collisions when density rises.
Dr Rowan Leith	My conclusion is methodological: treat emergence as an explanation to test, not as a label that replaces measurement at every stage of analysis.
Dr Rowan Leith	Murmuration research is strongest when reconstructed trajectories, weather records and falsifiable models converge instead of relying on visual spectacle alone.

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Reading

Question	Answer	Accepted variants
1	D	
2	A	
3	F	
4	C	
5	B	
6	E	
7	tree	
8	stop	
9	trunk	
10	composite	
11	seasoning yard	
12	young trees	
13	mature trees	
14	FALSE	
15	TRUE	
16	FALSE	
17	FALSE	
18	TRUE	
19	FALSE	
20	FALSE	
21	legs	
22	junctions	
23	wind noise	
24	contact points	
25	shapes	
26	signal	
27	iv	
28	vii	

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Question	Answer	Accepted variants
29	ii	
30	ix	
31	vi	
32	B	
33	C	
34	D	
35	A	
36	F	
37	A	
38	H	
39	C	
40	E	

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